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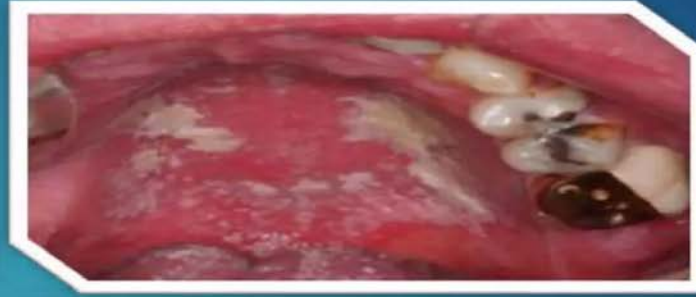
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# Approach to the Evaluation of the Patient

## Oral Mucosal Lesions



# Definition. of oral diagnosis :-

**"It is the art of using scientific knowledge to identify oral disease process and to distinguish one disease from another"**

**OR**

**"The use of scientific methods and knowledge to determine the cause and nature or behavior of the patient's disease or illness"**

# **Types of oral diagnosis**

- 1- comprehensive
- 2- emergency
- 3- spot diagnosis
- 4- differential diagnosis
- 5- provisional diagnosis
- 6- final diagnosis

## Oral Diagnosis and medicine

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OR

"The use of scientific methods and knowledge to determine the cause and nature or behavior of the patient's disease or illness"

### Types of oral diagnosis :-

- 1- **Comprehensive oral diagnosis :-** → Full diagnosis  
 It is a diagnostic assessment for all dental problems as revealed by :-

- MCQ
- Full history.
  - Clinical exam.
  - Use of diagnostic aids. → investigation

! It is done for the patients requiring total dental care.

- 2- **Emergency diagnosis :-** → عرصة

"It is the immediate diagnosis of the patient's complaint that requires immediate attention and management by the dentist (as) in the case of acute dental pain and accidental fractures"

- 3- **Spot (snap) diagnosis :-** → سبب

"It is simple cases where rapid diagnosis can be achieved perfectly, based on minimal data"

e.g. Palatal ulcer + history of eating hot food leading to diagnosis of food burn.

- 4- **Differential diagnosis :-** → D.D

"It is the collection of data to develop a list of two or more different diseases having common primary clinical presentation"

Note the most likely lesion is put on the top of the list according to clinical impression.

- 5- **(Working or provisional) Tentative diagnosis :-** → primary  
 "It is primary uncertain diagnosis before all diagnostic data are assembled"

Note in this case the final diagnosis is then reached by confirming the tentative or working diagnosis or changing it according to either response to treatment (+ve or -ve) or result of diagnosis aids e.g. biopsy.

X investigation

**6- Final diagnosis :-**

"It is the final diagnosis based on accurate appraisal of available data"

e.g. →

- Case history
- Clinical exam.
- Special investigations.

**✍ Scope of oral diagnosis and medicine :-**

" A doctor who cannot take a good history and a patient who cannot give one are in danger of giving and receiving bad treatment " **Paul D. white**

**[ Therefore the reasons for physical evaluation are :- ]**

- 1- To identify patients with undetected systemic disease that could be a serious threat to the life of the patient or that could be complicated by dental treatment.
- 2- To identify patients who are taking drugs or medication that could be interact with drugs that could be prescribed by the dentist.
- 3- To allow the dentist to modify the treatment plan in light or according to any systemic disease the patient may have or any drug he may be taking. سواء الدواء
- 4- To protect the patient and the dentist from commitment of any mal-practices.
- 5- To enable the dentist to select medical consultation regarding to the systemic disease the patient may have.
- 6- To help in establishment a good patient doctor relationship → leading to co-operation between patient and doctor.

## 1) Patient history

### Methods for obtaining the patient history :-

- 1- Printed questionnaires.
- 2- Patient interview.
- 3- Combination of both.

### Items of patient history :-

- 1- Patient identification. → Personal data
- 2- Source of information. → Patient word
- 3- Chief complaint.
- 4- History of chief complaint.
- 5- Dental history.
- 6- Medical history. → drug and disease
- 7- Social history.
- 8- Family history.
- 9- Review of systems. → Symptoms

### 1- Patient identification

Patient identification also called identifying data, administrative data or routine data.

The patient identification should be obtained and recorded and this includes :-

- 1- Code number of patients file.
- 2- Date of examinations.
- 3- Name of the patient (full).
- 4- Age (date of birth).
- 5- Gender (sex).
- 6- Birth place.
- 7- Race.
- 8- Address.
- 9- Phone number.
- 10- Occupation.
- 11- Marital status.
- 12- Parent name and address.
- 13- Physician name and address.

### Notes

" Never treat a stranger "

The patient should write the whole information himself on a printed form to avoid errors that commonly occur when such information is recorded by someone other than the individual, which include patient registration form ( Fig 1 A ) and Dental health questionnaire ( Fig 1 B ) as indicated in oral medicine case record below ( Fig 1 ).

**ORAL MEDICINE CASE RECORD ( Fig. 1 )**

Dentist's name .....

***A-Patient registration***

- Code number.....
- Date .....
- Name.....
- Date of birth (Age) .....
- Sex..... Male      Female
- Birth place .....
- Race .....
- Address .....
- Phone number :

Home.....

Office.....

Mobile.....

- Occupation .....
- Marital status .....
- Parent ( or guardian ) name and address .....
- Physician name and address .....

## 2 Chief complaint → is patient own word

It is symptom or symptoms that described by the patient and related to the present illness or abnormal condition that promoted the patient to treat it.

The patient comes to the doctor for some definite reason or check up.

**This is in brief the answer to the question :-**

→ " what symptom concerns you the most? "

OR

→ " what brought you to see me today? "

For most patients, the chief complaint is usually obtained by asking the patient an open-ended question rather than closed-ended or other types of question.

The patient will sometimes answer by giving medical diagnosis such as hypertension, but this is not the right answer and should be avoided.

The chief complaint may be a single complaint or multiple complaints, multiple complaints should be listed in order of importance to the patient and not for the value of treatment for the doctor.

**The chief complaint affected by :-**

- 1- Patient memory.
- 2- The age of the patient.
- 3- The mental attitude and personality of patient.
- 4- The prestige of the dentist.

**Criteria of chief complaint :-**

- 1- It recorded according to the patient own words.
- 2- It should be specific and understood by the examiner.

**Note Ex**

Complaint may be written as follows :-

- 1- Abdominal pain for one month.
- 2- Vomiting for one day.
- 3- Tooth pain for two days.

**The most common chief complaint**

Usually the patient comes to the dental clinic complaining of one or more of the following common complaint :-

- 1- Pain → which may be most
  - Somatic → injury → wound → tooth pain
  - Neurogenic → pain
  - Psychogenic → stress

② Burning sensation → e.g.

- Fungal infection.
- Viral infection.
- Fissured tongue.
- Geographic tongue.
- Anemia.
- Coating atrophy of tongue.
- Vitamin deficiency.
- Xerostomia condition.
- Bacterial infection.

③ Bleeding → e.g.

- Bleeding may occur following surgery.
- Allergies.
- Tumors.
- Bleeding gums.
- Periodontal diseases.
- Uncontrolled blood disorders.

★★★ ④ Dry mouth → e.g.

- ★ Drug therapy. most side effect  
 - Sjogren's syndrome. known etiology  
 - Post-radiation therapy.  
 - Chemotherapy.  
 - Mikulicz's disease.

⑤ Bad taste → e.g.

- ★ ANUG. → metallic taste  
 - Dental caries.  
 - Heavy smoking.  
 - Periodontal disease.  
 - Uremia.  
 - Hypertension.
- ★ Diabetes. → a stome breath

⑥ Paraesthesia and numbness → e.g.

- Pressure on the nerve.
- Injury to the nerve.
- Drugs ( sedatives, hypnotics streptomycin prolonged use ).

⑦ Delayed tooth eruption → e.g.

- Malposed tooth.
- Cysts.
- Maldevelopment.
- Tumors.
- Odontomas.
- hypothyroidism

8. Halitosis → e.g. Bad odor ↔ Local  
↔ Systemic

- Poor oral hygiene. L
- Periodontal disease. L
- ANUG. L
- Oral cancer. L
- Sinus infection. S
- Diabetes. S
- Nasal infection. S
- Gastric problems. S
- Spicy food. L
- Decayed teeth. L
- Third molar opercula. L

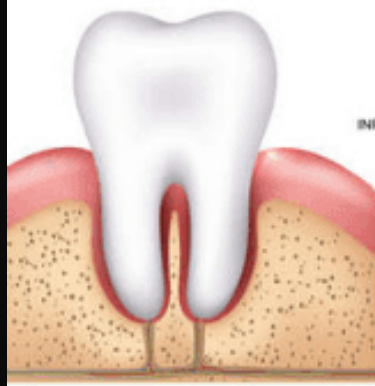
Soft tissue over Tooth  
will form colicula

9. T.M.J disorders → clicking or pain with or without limitation of jaw function.

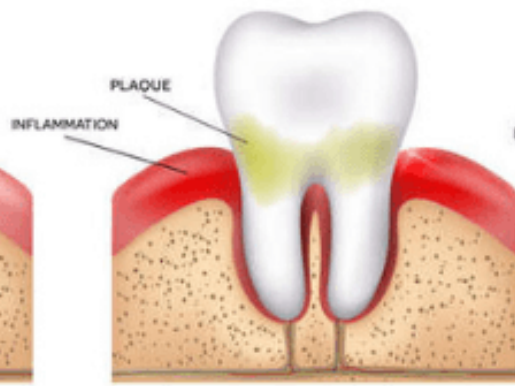
10. Swelling → e.g.

- soft tissue swelling such as facial cellulitis.
- Hard tissue swelling such as Paget's disease and ameloblastoma.

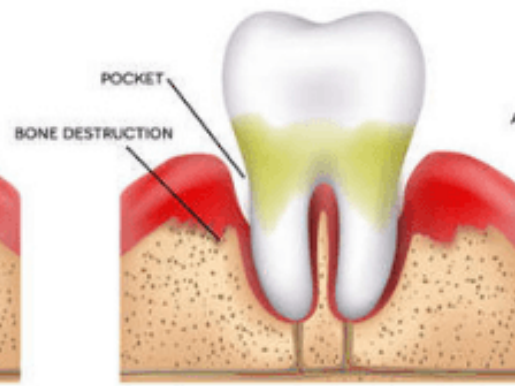
# Gingivitis VS Periodontitis



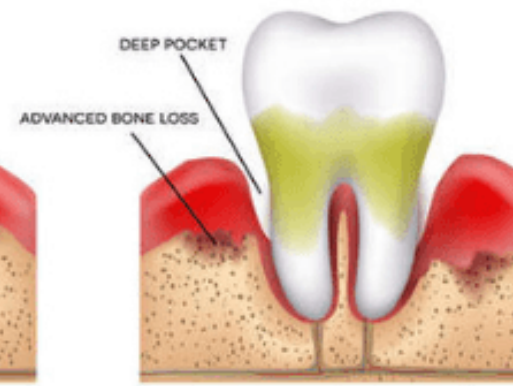
Healthy Tooth  
and Gums



Gingivitis



Periodontitis



Advanced  
Periodontitis